

These are all YAML (YAML Ain't Markup Language) files. *YAML* is a language designed for writing configuration files; it's made to be read easily by both humans and computers. You can write or modify a typical YAML file by hand, but a computer can also read and interpret the file unambiguously.

YAML files are great for deployment configuration, because they give you a good deal of control over what happens during the deployment process.

Making Hidden Files Visible

Most operating systems hide files and folders that begin with a dot, such as *.platform*. When you open a file browser, you won't see these kinds of files and folders by default. But as a programmer, you'll need to see them. Here's how to view hidden files, depending on your operating system:

- On Windows, open Windows Explorer, and then open a folder such as *Desktop*. Click the **View** tab, and make sure **File name extensions** and **Hidden items** are checked.
- On macOS, you can press ⌘-SHIFT-.(dot) in any Finder window to see hidden files and folders.
- On Linux systems such as Ubuntu, you can press CTRL-H in any file browser to display hidden files and folders. To make this setting permanent, open a file browser such as Nautilus and click the options tab (indicated by three lines). Select the **Show Hidden Files** checkbox.

The *.platform.app.yaml* Configuration File

The first configuration file is the longest, because it controls the overall deployment process. We'll show it in parts; you can either enter it by hand in your text editor or download a copy from the online resources at https://ehmatthes.github.io/pcc_3e.

Here's the first part of *.platform.app.yaml*, which should be saved in the same directory as *manage.py*:

```
.platform ❶ name: "ll_project"
.app.yaml type: "python:3.10"

❷ relationships:
    database: "db:postgresql"

# The configuration of the app when it's exposed to the web.
❸ web:
    upstream:
        socket_family: unix
    commands:
❹     start: "gunicorn -w 4 -b unix:$SOCKET ll_project.wsgi:application"
❺     locations:
        "/":
            passthru: true
        "/static":
```